

SCRIPT-CONTROLLED ACL

Restrict Record Access Based on Field Value

Document Type	Technical Documentation
Platform	ServiceNow
Security Control	Access Control List (ACL)
Access Method	Script-controlled record access based on a field value

1. Objective

The objective is to use a Scripted ACL in ServiceNow to restrict access to records based on the value of a specific field. The ACL evaluates the record at runtime and allows or denies access according to the defined condition.

2. Requirement

Users should be able to access a record only when the selected field contains the permitted value. If the field does not contain the permitted value, the ACL denies access.

- Example field: u_access_level
- Allowed value: Internal
- If u_access_level = Internal → access is allowed.
- If u_access_level is another value → access is denied.

3. ACL Configuration

Configuration	Value
Table	Target table, for example Incident [incident]
Operation	Read
Type	Record ACL
Requires role	Optional; depends on the requirement
Condition	Can be left empty when the decision is handled by the script
Script	Checks the required field value and sets the ACL result

4. Sample Script

```
(function () {  
    // Allow admin users full access  
    if (gs.hasRole('admin')) {  
        return true;  
    }  
    // Allow only EEE branch users to see EEE records  
    if (gs.hasRole('bb1')){  
        return true;  
    }  
})
```

```
// Deny access for all others  
  
return false;  
  
})();
```

5. Working

1. The user requests access to a record.
2. ServiceNow evaluates the applicable ACL.
3. The ACL script reads the selected field value from the current record.
4. If the value matches the permitted value, the script returns true and access is allowed.
5. If the value does not match, the script returns false and access is denied.

6. Data Flow

Step	Component	Data / Action
1	User	Requests access to a record
2	ACL	Receives the access request
3	ACL Script	Checks the configured field value
4	Decision	Match → Allow; No match → Deny

7. Example Scenario

Suppose an Incident table contains a field named `u_access_level`. The organization requires records marked 'Internal' to be available only through the ACL rule. When a user attempts to read an Incident, the ACL checks `u_access_level`. Records with the value 'Internal' pass the script; records with other values fail the script.

8. Expected Result

- Matching field value → ACL returns true → record access is granted.
- Non-matching field value → ACL returns false → record access is denied.
- The rule can be adapted for different tables, fields, values, roles, or access operations.

9. Important Notes

- Use the appropriate ACL operation such as read, write, create, or delete.
- Test the ACL with users having different roles and different field values.
- Record ACLs should be designed carefully because they control access to data.
- The field name and permitted value in the sample script must be replaced with the actual requirement.